

FRESH LOOK

These new labels come with impressive repertoires and international experience to boot. Front row girls, please take note.



PRRIYA & CHINTAN

Parson's School of Design graduate Chintan has worked for Calvin Klein and Randy Rahm. Prriya brings her knowledge of embroideries to their joint label. Their collection Oasis is inspired by nature and brings a vibrant colour palette to the ramp.



ASHISH, VIRAL AND VIKRANT for Virtues

Viral comes armed with an internship at the House of Dior. While Vikrant is a Delhi-based designer, Ashish brings his management skills. Their collection Indian High focuses on "Indian embroideries, colours, textiles and cuts".

PRASHANT VERMA

With names like John Galiano, Christian Dior and Alexander McQueen on his resume, his eponymous label Prashant already has fashion watchers begging for more. His collection Frission is a blend of old Hollywood bling and contemporary finesse.



DRASHTA SARVAIYA

'Comfort with style' is the adage of this Delhi designer's collection christened Paradiso Fondare, inspired by the Charles Dickens novel *Great Expectations*. Sarvaiya combines a unique sense of detail with quirk and colour in this "free-spirited" line.

ELISHA W

This graduate from the London College of Fashion has worked with European designer Betty Jackson. Her luxury prêt collection Viva de Glam brings red carpet couture to fashion week. She uses unconventional embellishments and design elements.

Models: MANASVI and NAYAN courtesy Elite Model Management

projects that we are currently undertaking". Veteran virtuoso Tarun Tahiliani, however, is "back-peddling and looking at India anew" with a collection that's a unique mix of Kutch and Kenya, where tribal influences meet Swarovski bras and waistlets. "If you want to be a professional and build your brand, you should show in India as well as abroad. Build your brand here first and then take it to the world," advises Tahiliani.

Thankfully, FDCI's ingenuity in introducing ten new designers as part of the tenth edition's initiative Hi-5 Duo will fill up the empty show slots. FDCI Director-General Rathi Vinay Jha defends the spring-summer low show. "It's taken six years of concentrated effort for autumn-winter to establish itself and it's only been two years since the spring-summer season was introduced," says Jha. It's time for the young trend turks to move in for the kill. Enter Prashant Verma, Drashta Sarvaiya, Elisha W, Gauri Bajoria, Dubai-based duo Meher Mirchandani and Riddhima Whabi, Varun Sardana, Prriya & Chintan, Zeal by Shubhra and Ashish, Viral and Vikrant for Virtues,

MODEL MISS

They are the show-stoppers; the heavenly bodies who play muse to couturiers, garb themselves in designer dreams and keep the fashion week ramp sizzling. And this year, some of India's more established models are all set to face some stiff competition. In keeping with the tenth edition theme, ten new female models will be launched on the spring-summer platform. With fresh talent like former Miss Sri Lanka Jacqueline Fernandez and other leggy beauties like Garima Parnami, Praneet Grewal, Lisa Haydon and Shipra Malik set to sizzle on the ramp, this summer promises to be doubly hot. Maybe now designers will see beyond Bhavna Sharma, Sapna Kumar and Carol Gracias. And even as sniggers of contractual restrictions abound, Jha clears the air. "We wanted models to sign up for both seasons together. The mix helps us with budgeting. There was no contract barring any model from participating in any parallel event."

who will showcase in the Hi-5 Duo line-up. "These are established labels that already have interesting portfolios," says Jha.

Even as wifw moves into a "dedicated trade venue" Pragati Maidan, fashion designers and watchers are hoping for some serious business. Says Jha, "Pragati Maidan not only provides us the space to accommodate this ever-growing event, it also helps us to take forward our business of fashion." Organisers have amplified facilities to make the venue more fashion-friendly, with Olive Bar & Kitchen dishing out Mediterranean meals and lounges, salons and reflexology adding the pampering touch. And with wifw paying tribute to Rohit Khosla, "the de facto founder of the modern fashion industry in India", these sidelights might make up for the absence of Arora's brand of madness and Soni's subtle finesse. With visits by Asociacion Creadores de Moda de España (Spanish Fashion Council) President Modesto Lomba Caneda and Executive Director Lucía Cordeiro Cuesta, maybe some Spanish sangria is in order.